

# /hai — Week 5 Report

Sai Pranavi Jeedigunta | Mycroft Project 29

July 27 – August 2, 2026 (*report compiled retroactively, Aug 3*)

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## Hours Log

| Date                    | Activity                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Hours |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Mon July 27             | Video production and build (toolkit setup carryover, script fact-check, Manim scenes, QC debugging, documentation, GitHub push); renewal packet assembly (engagement screenshots, Substack link check, email drafting); reviewed sprint stand-up meeting notes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | ~10.0 |
| Tue July 28 – Sun Aug 2 | Finalized and resubmitted signed volunteer agreement following HR/Prof. Brown review; received and responded to direct feedback on Video 1 (naming, ownership, honesty about issues/next steps); researched SEVP Portal employment-reporting requirements and resolved an end-date field ambiguity for continuous employment; reviewed Brutalist tool tutorial/walkthrough to prepare for two additional required videos; continued n8n workflow research for Project 29; began scripting a second video (facial recognition explainer) with sourced NIST research | ~10.0 |
| Total                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ~20.0 |

## Accomplishments

### 1. Finalized agreement renewal through August – October 2026

Completed and submitted a signed volunteer agreement reflecting the new term (08/01–10/31/2026), matching the exact structure and personal details of the original signed agreement. Agreement was resubmitted after supplementary materials (chapter workbooks, GitHub report links, Substack articles) were added, then reviewed and countersigned by Prof. Nicholas Brown. Renewal is fully closed.

### 2. Received and engaged with direct, substantive feedback on Video 1

Prof. Brown confirmed the video was acceptable for the renewal but flagged specific issues: use of first name rather than anonymity, “we” instead of “I” for individual work, and a narrative that implied the pipeline work went perfectly without discussing real issues or next steps. This is a direct, external instance of the fluency-trap failure mode studied in Chapter 1 — a polished artifact that omitted the friction and uncertainty behind it. Replied to acknowledge the feedback and commit to specific corrections in future videos.

### 3. Resolved a genuine SEVP compliance ambiguity through direct research

Investigated how to report continuing OPT employment in the SEVP Portal after realizing an employment end date had never been entered. Determined, based on the portal's own field instructions (“leave this field blank if you do not know when your job will end”), that leaving the end date blank was the more accurate choice given genuine uncertainty about when the position will end — rather than guessing a date that could later prove inaccurate.

### 4. Began building the two videos required going forward (work update + general AI topic)

Reviewed a full internal tutorial/walkthrough of the Brutalist video toolkit to understand the end-to-end workflow (plan → human gate/pass → render), ahead of producing this cycle's two required videos. Drafted a full script and tool prompt for the general AI-topic video: a Deep Explainer on how facial recognition works, covering the

technical pipeline (detection, embedding, comparison, similarity score), legitimate and unnecessary use cases, and a sourced, balanced treatment of NIST's demographic-accuracy findings — explicitly connecting the finding that a match score is a probability, not a certainty, back to the fluency-trap concept from Chapter 1.

## Struggle Documentation

The most significant friction this week was external, not self-identified: Prof. Brown's feedback on Video 1 named a real gap that had not been caught internally — the video's polish had obscured the actual process behind it, exactly the failure pattern studied in Chapter 1. Recognizing that this feedback was substantive rather than stylistic, and that it applied a concept from this month's own coursework back onto this month's own work, required setting aside any impulse to treat the note as a minor formatting request.

A second, quieter struggle: the SEVP end-date field appeared at first to require a decision (pick a date, likely 10/31/2026 matching the agreement term). Working through it required recognizing that the honest answer was uncertainty itself — a new job could end this position well before the agreement term does — and that the field's own instructions supported leaving it blank rather than supplying a plausible-but-unconfirmed date. This is the same evidentiary discipline as the Chapter 1 material: a confident-looking answer is not the same as a correct one.

## Tier Justification

**Tier 4 — Judgment and Supervision:** Correctly resolving the SEVP end-date ambiguity required judgment about what the field was actually asking, not just what value would look complete. Choosing to leave it blank, against the instinct to fill every field, reflects the same supervision discipline studied this month.

**Tier 3 — Social and Ethical:** Receiving direct, critical feedback from Prof. Brown on a completed piece of work and responding professionally — acknowledging the substance of the critique rather than defending the original video — required navigating a real, slightly uncomfortable professional interaction honestly.

**Tier 1 — AI Fluency:** Learned and internalized the Brutalist video-toolkit workflow (plan, human gate/pass, render) well enough to plan a second video independently, including sourcing and fact-checking a genuinely contested empirical claim (facial recognition demographic bias) against NIST's own published data rather than a secondhand summary.

**Tier 5 — Causal Reasoning (in progress):** The facial recognition video script required holding two true findings in tension — that most deployed algorithms show real demographic bias, and that the best-performing algorithms show almost none — without collapsing the nuance into a simpler, less accurate claim in either direction.

## Unresolved

- Video 1 has not yet been revised per Prof. Brown's feedback (name, pronoun, issues/next-steps)
- Video 2 (facial recognition Deep Explainer) scripted and sourced but not yet built/rendered
- Video 3 (project work-update video) not yet started
- Project 29 pipeline backlog unchanged: Group A item A7, Group B items B2/B3, Group D additions
- n8n workflow research this week not yet translated into a specific next fix or documented finding

## Next Steps — Week 6

- Revise Video 1 per Prof. Brown's feedback, or fold corrections into the two new videos and note the original's limitations honestly

- Build Video 2 (facial recognition Deep Explainer) using Brutalist, with first-person narration under Sai Pranavi's own name
- Build Video 3 (work-update video) covering renewal completion and current pipeline status, applying the same naming/ownership/honesty standard from the start
- Translate this week's n8n research into a concrete next fix (B2 source classification flagged as highest priority)
- File this week's Substack article

## Compliance Notes

| Item                | Status                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Volunteer agreement | Renewed and countersigned — August 1 to October 31, 2026                                                                                                                              |
| SEVP portal         | Employer entry confirmed current; employment end date intentionally left blank per portal instructions, given genuine uncertainty about actual end date                               |
| Unique ID           | 241                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Video requirement   | Two videos/week confirmed as standing requirement (one work update, one AI topic) per July 28 stand-up. One video (Video 1) completed and flagged for revision; two more in progress. |
| CRITIQ              | Standing requirement — no new long-form article published this week to route through it                                                                                               |

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Week 5 session duration: approximately 20 documented hours (report compiled retroactively on August 3, one week after the reporting period)